

KEY TOPIC 1 CHRONOLOGICAL ENQUIRY SEQUENCE • 1558–1569**Queen, Government and Religion, 1558–69***Accession, Religious Settlement, Puritan & Catholic Challenges, and Mary, Queen of Scots*

HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD • C. 1558–1560

NPG 5175 • NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY • LONDON

Queen Elizabeth I in Coronation Robes

Unknown English Artist • Queen Elizabeth I depicted at her accession wearing patterned cloth of gold coronation robes, holding the orb and sceptre as symbols of sovereign monarchical power. Accession Shelfmark NPG 5175.

HISTORICAL PRIMARY SOURCE

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 MASTER ARCHIVE

PUPIL WORKBOOK & ASSESSMENTPEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY • PAPER 2: EARLY ELIZABETHAN ENGLAND, 1558–1588
• KEY TOPIC 1

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY SPECIFICATION CONTENT**OFFICIAL SPECIFICATION CONTENT****1. THE SITUATION ON ACCESSION (1558)**

- Elizabethan society & structure of government (Monarch, Privy Council, Parliament, JPs)
- Virgin Queen: problems of gender, marriage, and disputed Tudor legitimacy
- Financial weaknesses & £300,000 Crown debt inherited from Mary I
- Foreign threats: French dominance, Scotland, and the loss of Calais (1558)

2. THE RELIGIOUS SETTLEMENT (1559)

- Act of Supremacy (1559): Supreme Governor of the Church of England
- Act of Uniformity (1559): Book of Common Prayer & church attendance fines
- Royal Injunctions (1559): 57 instructions enforcing Protestant conformity
- Role of Church of England in enforcing settlement & national administration

3. CHALLENGES & MARY QUEEN OF SCOTS

- The Puritan Challenge: Crucifix and Vestments Controversies (1566)
- The Catholic Challenge: Papacy, Counter-Reformation, and recusancy
- Mary, Queen of Scots: Claim to English throne & flight to England (1568)
- Relations between Elizabeth & Mary: House arrest & Casket Letters inquiry

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

17 NOV 1558 • Accession of Elizabeth I & Council Appointments

Key Topic 1.1

Mary I dies; 25-year-old Elizabeth succeeds to the throne. She immediately appoints trusted Protestant statesman Sir William Cecil as her Principal Secretary, confronting £300,000 in Crown debts and French military forces stationed in Scotland.

MAY 1559 • The Acts of Supremacy & Uniformity (The Settlement)

Key Topic 1.2

Parliament passes the Religious Settlement. The Act of Supremacy establishes Elizabeth as 'Supreme Governor' of the Church of England; the Act of Uniformity mandates the 1559 Book of Common Prayer and imposes a 1 shilling fine for recusancy.

SUMMER 1559 • The Royal Injunctions & National Visitations

Key Topic 1.2

The Crown issues 57 Royal Injunctions enforcing Protestant worship. Clergy must preach royal supremacy, condemn papal authority, report recusants, and use English bibles. National visitations by 125 commissioners inspect parish compliance.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 1)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

1563 • The Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion

Key Topic 1.2

Convocation of the Church of England establishes the 39 Articles, formally defining Anglican doctrine as a compromise between Reformed Calvinist theology (justification by faith alone) and traditional liturgical structure with bishops and cathedrals.

1566 • The Vestments Controversy & Puritan Dissent

Key Topic 1.3

Archbishop Matthew Parker issues the 'Book of Advertisements' requiring all clergy to wear the surplice and tippet. In London, 37 Puritan vicars refuse to wear Catholic-style vestments and are deprived of their livings, revealing deep Protestant divisions.

MAY 1568 • Mary Queen of Scots Flees to England

Key Topic 1.4

Following the murder of Lord Darnley and defeat at Carberry Hill, Catholic Mary Stuart flees Scotland in a fishing boat to Workington, Cumberland. Elizabeth places her under armed house arrest, triggering twenty years of Catholic conspiracy.

How dangerous was the crisis facing Elizabeth I upon her accession in 1558?

Key Topic 1.1: Society, Government, Legitimacy, Marriage, Debt & Foreign Threats

Key Specification Focus: Elizabethan government (Monarch, Privy Council, Parliament, Lords Lieutenant, JPs); challenges of gender, legitimacy, and marriage; financial debt; foreign threats from France and Scotland.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Which Tudor monarch was Elizabeth I's father?

2. Who was Elizabeth I's mother, executed in 1536?

3. Which Catholic queen preceded Elizabeth on the throne (1553–58)?

4. What religion was Queen Elizabeth I?

5. What ancient English possession in France was lost in January 1558?

6. Approximately how much Crown debt did Elizabeth inherit in 1558?

7. Who did Elizabeth appoint as her trusted Principal Secretary in 1558?

8. Which institution had the sole legal power to grant monarchical taxes?

9. Which unpaid local officials maintained law and order in counties?

10. Which northern kingdom was ruled by Mary of Guise in 1558?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Royal Prerogative: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Crown Patronage:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between the monarch's supreme legal right to make foreign policy and religion decisions alone (**Royal Prerogative**) and the granting of titles, lands, and monopolies to secure political loyalty (**Crown Patronage**):

Sentence Starter: *While Royal Prerogative established that..., Crown Patronage operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the role of the Privy Council in 1558.

Target Guidance: Point (A group of 19 noble advisors who guided royal policy and administration) • Fact (Led by William Cecil, they debated daily on war, finance, and treason, but the Queen had the final prerogative).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was that the Privy Council... Specifically, led by Sir William Cecil, they...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2022 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the financial weaknesses Elizabeth faced in 1558.

Target Guidance: Point (The Crown was in crippling debt of £300,000 inherited from Mary I) • Fact (Crown income had fallen due to inflation and selling royal land; debasement of the coinage ruined English credit abroad).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the massive Crown debt inherited from Mary I... Specifically, the debt stood at...

Was Elizabeth's Religious Settlement a brilliant compromise or an unstable truce?

Key Topic 1.2: Act of Supremacy, Act of Uniformity, Royal Injunctions & The Prayer Book

Key Specification Focus: The Act of Supremacy (1559); the Act of Uniformity (1559); the Royal Injunctions (1559); the Book of Common Prayer; the role of the Church of England.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. What title did Henry VIII claim over the Church of England in 1534?

2. What language was the Catholic Latin Mass spoken in?

3. What term describes Protestants who wanted to purify the Church of all Catholic practices?

4. What was the official fine for refusing to attend church under the 1559 Act of Uniformity?

5. What title did Elizabeth I adopt under the 1559 Act of Supremacy?

6. What English prayer book was made compulsory in all parish churches in 1559?

7. What official set of 57 instructions enforced the 1559 Settlement?

8. What was a Catholic called who refused to attend Anglican church services?

9. How many Marian Catholic bishops refused the Oath of Supremacy in 1559?

10. Who was appointed Elizabeth's first Protestant Archbishop of Canterbury in 1559?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Act of Supremacy: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Act of Uniformity:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between the constitutional law establishing the monarch's control over church leadership (**Act of Supremacy**) and the liturgical law governing church services and prayer books (**Act of Uniformity**):

Sentence Starter: While Act of Supremacy established that..., Act of Uniformity operated differently because...

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel SAMs (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559).

Target Guidance: Point (Made Elizabeth Supreme Governor of the Church of England rather than Supreme Head) • Fact (All clergy and royal officials had to take an Oath of Supremacy acknowledging her title or lose their posts).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was that Elizabeth took the title of Supreme Governor... Specifically, this required all clergy to...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel June 2023 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Royal Injunctions of 1559.

Target Guidance: Point (A set of 57 practical instructions issued by William Cecil to enforce church conformity) • Fact (Commanded clergy to preach royal supremacy, keep an English Bible, report recusants, and ban unapproved preaching).

Sentence Stems: One key feature of the Royal Injunctions was to enforce uniform Protestant practice... Specifically, they ordered that...

EDEXCEL SAMS (Q3)

Score: [/ 20]

‘Elizabeth’s religious settlement of 1559 was completely successful in pleasing all religious groups.’ How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer:

- The Act of Uniformity (1559)
- The Puritan challenge

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CRITERIA 1: SUCCESSFUL VIA MEDIA

POINT
1

Explain how the Settlement successfully achieved a broad Middle Way: moderate Protestant theology (English services, Book of Common Prayer) combined with Catholic outward ritual (vestments, candles) to prevent civil war.

2. CRITERIA 2: PURITAN DISCONTENT

POINT
2

Explain that the Settlement failed to satisfy zealous Puritans: they condemned the crucifix and vestments as "idolatrous popish rags" and challenged Elizabeth's authority in the 1566 Vestments Controversy.

3. CRITERIA 3: CATHOLIC ALIENATION

POINT
3

Explain that devout Catholics could not accept Elizabeth as Supreme Governor; almost all Catholic bishops resigned in 1559, recusancy grew in the North, and the Pope later excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570.

Analytical Connectives: On the one hand, the settlement was highly effective because... • Crucially, by adopting the title Supreme Governor, Elizabeth... • In direct contrast, radical Puritans remained dissatisfied because... • Furthermore, traditional Catholics viewed the settlement as heretical because... • Weighing these factors, I conclude that while the settlement prevented immediate religious war, it was not completely successful because...

Word Bank: Settlement • Supreme Governor • Book of Common Prayer • Surplice • Middle Way (Via Media) • Puritans • Recusancy • Compromise • Vestments Controversy

Timeline Mission: Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2). In Milestone 2, sketch the open English Book of Common Prayer and note the 1 shilling recusancy fine.

Which group posed the greater danger to Elizabeth: zealous Puritans or defiant Catholics?

Key Topic 1.3: Crucifix Controversy, Vestments Controversy, Recusancy & The Papacy

Key Specification Focus: The nature and extent of the Puritan challenge (crucifix and vestments controversies); the nature and extent of the Catholic challenge (the papacy, recusancy, and foreign Catholic powers).

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS) Score: [/ 10]

1. What Latin term means "the middle way", describing Elizabeth's settlement?
2. Which white linen robe did Puritans refuse to wear during church services?
3. Which Archbishop of Canterbury issued the 1566 Book of Advertisements?
4. How many London priests were dismissed in 1566 for refusing to wear vestments?
5. What object did Elizabeth place in the Royal Chapel that outraged Puritans?
6. What Catholic movement aimed to stamp out Protestantism across Europe?
7. Which Catholic king ruled Spain, the Netherlands, and the Spanish Empire?
8. What region of England was most heavily Catholic in the 1560s?
9. What council of Catholic clergy (1545–63) reaffirmed Catholic doctrines?
10. Did King Philip II of Spain immediately attack Elizabeth in 1559?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Puritan Nonconformity: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Catholic Recusancy:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between Protestant clergy refusing to obey royal rules on vestments and ornaments (**Puritan Nonconformity**) and Catholic believers refusing to attend Anglican Sunday church services (**Catholic Recusancy**):

Sentence Starter: *While Puritan Nonconformity established that..., Catholic Recusancy operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] Edexcel November 2020 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Vestments Controversy (1566).

Target Guidance: *Point (Puritan vicars refused to wear the surplice ordered by Archbishop Parker) • Fact (Parker held an exhibition in London; 37 clergy refused to conform and were stripped of their livings and church posts).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the clash over clerical dress... Specifically, Archbishop Parker insisted on the surplice, but 37 London clergy...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS] Edexcel June 2024 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of recusancy in early Elizabethan England.

Target Guidance: *Point (Catholics secretly practiced the Latin Mass and refused compulsory Sunday church services) • Fact (They paid a 1 shilling fine each week; in the North, wealthy Catholic gentry protected recusant priests).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature of recusancy was refusal to attend the new Anglican church... Specifically, recusants held secret Latin masses and paid...

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q2)

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why the Puritans challenged Elizabeth's religious settlement between 1559 and 1566.

You may use in your answer: • Vestments • The Crucifix Controversy *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CAUSE 1: VESTMENTS & POPISH RAGS

POINT
1

Explain that Puritans, influenced by Genevan Calvinism, viewed priestly vestments (surplices) as unscriptural Catholic idolatry that set clergy apart from ordinary congregations.

2. CAUSE 2: CRUCIFIXES & GRAVEN IMAGES

POINT
2

Explain that Puritans believed crucifixes violated the Ten Commandments against graven images; several Puritan bishops threatened to resign when Elizabeth insisted on a crucifix in her chapel.

3. CAUSE 3: BISHOPS & LITURGICAL PURITY

POINT
3

Explain that Puritans wanted to eradicate the hierarchy of bishops and eradicate holy days, organs, and kneeling at communion, aiming for an entirely purified biblical church.

Analytical Connectives: The Puritans challenged the religious settlement primarily because... • Specifically, their Calvinist theology taught that... • This led directly to conflict over vestments when... • In addition, the crucifix controversy demonstrated that... • Consequently, Puritans believed Elizabeth had stopped halfway in reforming...

Word Bank: Calvinism • Vestments Controversy (1566) • Crucifix • Surplice • Graven images • Idolatry • Archbishop Parker • Book of Advertisements • Nonconformist

Timeline Mission: Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the plain Puritan surplice and the crossed-out Catholic crucifix.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Was Mary, Queen of Scots an innocent royal refugee or an existential threat to the realm?

Key Topic 1.4: Royal Legitimacy, Flight to England (1568), Casket Letters & House Arrest

Key Specification Focus: Mary, Queen of Scots: her claim to the English throne; her arrival in England in 1568; relations between Elizabeth and Mary (1568–69); the Casket Letters inquiry.

• 'DO NOW' RETRIEVAL DRILL (10 RECALL QUESTIONS)

Score: [/ 10]

1. Who was Mary, Queen of Scots' first husband, King of France?

2. Which grandmother gave Mary Stuart a legitimate claim to the English throne?

3. What religion was Mary, Queen of Scots?

4. Who was Mary's second husband, found strangled after Kirk o'Field exploded in 1567?

5. Whom did Mary marry shortly after Darnley's suspicious death?

6. In what year did Mary Stuart flee across the border into England?

7. In what northern castle was Mary first held under armed house arrest?

8. What alleged love letters were presented to prove Mary murdered Darnley?

9. Did Elizabeth formally find Mary guilty of murder at the York Inquiry in 1568–69?

10. Which powerful Catholic noble family in France was Mary closely related to?

• CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY

HISTORICAL TERMINOLOGY

Sovereign Immunity: Key Disciplinary Concept | **Casket Letters:** Key Disciplinary Concept

Distinguish between the sacred legal principle that anointed monarchs cannot be tried by courts (**Sovereign Immunity**) and the controversial intercepted casket documents used to discredit Mary Stuart (**Casket Letters**):

Sentence Starter: *While Sovereign Immunity established that..., Casket Letters operated differently because...*

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

Edexcel November 2021 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of Mary, Queen of Scots' claim to the English throne.

Target Guidance: *Point (Mary was the great-granddaughter of Henry VII through Margaret Tudor) • Fact (Because Catholics viewed Elizabeth as illegitimate, many regarded Mary as the rightful, legitimate Catholic Queen of England).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Mary's legitimate Tudor bloodline... Specifically, as great-granddaughter of Henry VII, English Catholics viewed her as...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ High-Yield Forecast (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the inquiry into the Casket Letters (1568–69).

Target Guidance: *Point (A commission held at York and Westminster to investigate whether Mary plotted Darnley's murder) • Fact (Elizabeth reached a "not proven" verdict; this allowed her to keep Mary detained in England without executing an anointed queen).*

Sentence Stems: One key feature of the Casket Letters inquiry was to determine Mary's guilt... Specifically, the inquiry concluded with a verdict of...

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q3A)

Score: [/ 20]

‘The arrival of Mary, Queen of Scots in England in 1568 was the main cause of instability in Elizabethan government.’ How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer:

• Mary’s claim to the throne

• Religious divisions in the North

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CRITERIA 1: MARY AS CATHOLIC FIGUREHEAD

POINT 1

Explain how Mary’s physical presence provided a live, legitimate Catholic alternative to Elizabeth, immediately attracting discontented northern nobles and foreign Catholic conspirators.

2. CRITERIA 2: PRE-EXISTING NORTHERN DISCONTENT

POINT 2

Explain that the North was already deeply Catholic and alienated by Cecil’s centralizing Protestant government; the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland had lost land and influence before 1568.

3. CRITERIA 3: SUCCESSION & DIPLOMATIC RISK

POINT 3

Explain that Elizabeth had no heir; Mary’s presence forced foreign powers (France, Spain, Papacy) to view Elizabeth as expendable, turning Mary into a catalyst for domestic rebellion.

Analytical Connectives: Mary’s arrival was undeniably a major cause of instability because... • Specifically, her presence gave English Catholics a figurehead who... • However, severe instability already existed because the northern nobility... • Furthermore, Elizabeth’s refusal to marry meant that... • On balance, while northern grievances were deep-seated, Mary’s arrival was the decisive catalyst because...

Word Bank: Mary, Queen of Scots • Legitimacy • Anointed Queen • Casket Letters • Carlisle Castle • Northern Earls • Succession • Catholic Figurehead • House arrest

Timeline Mission: Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch Carlisle Castle where Mary Stuart was first held under house arrest in 1568.

ARCHIVAL & CONCEPTUAL BLUEPRINT • STRUCTURE OF GOVERNMENT & RELIGIOUS SPECTRUM

1. ANATOMY OF ELIZABETHAN GOVERNMENT: POWER, PATRONAGE & PREROGATIVE		
 The Monarch (Queen Elizabeth I): Ruled by Divine Right. Controlled Royal Prerogative: deciding foreign policy, declaring war, marriage, and religion. Could summon and dismiss Parliament at will.	 The Privy Council (Led by William Cecil): Approx. 19 trusted senior advisors who met daily. Managed government expenditure, state security, military logistics, and drafted royal legislation.	
 Parliament (Lords & Commons): Met only 10 times in 44 years. Crucial power: approving extraordinary taxation (subsidies) and passing statute laws. Free speech was strictly limited by the Queen.	 Lords Lieutenant & Justices of the Peace (JPs): Lords Lieutenant trained county militias. Unpaid JPs (gentry) enforced laws locally: collected taxes, regulated wages, punished beggars, and tracked recusants.	
2. THE ELIZABETHAN RELIGIOUS SPECTRUM: RADICAL PURITANISM VS THE MIDDLE WAY VS ROMAN CATHOLICISM		
PURITAN REFORMERS	ELIZABETH'S VIA MEDIA (1559)	ROMAN CATHOLIC CHURCH
• Leader: John Calvin (Geneva) • Church Government: Committees of presbyters (no bishops) • Services: Plain English, long sermons • Ornaments: No vestments (surplices), no crucifixes, plain communion tables • Sacraments: 2 (Baptism & Communion) • Attitude to Queen: Wanted further radical purification	• Supreme Governor: Queen Elizabeth I • Hierarchy: Kept Archbishops and Bishops • Services: English Book of Common Prayer • Ornaments: Clergy wear white surplice; candles and music permitted • Communion: Deliberately ambiguous wording accepting spiritual presence • Recusancy: 1 shilling fine for non-attendance	• Supreme Head: The Pope in Rome • Hierarchy: Cardinals, Bishops, Priests • Services: Traditional Latin Mass • Ornaments: Rich embroidered vestments, crucifixes, statues of saints, altars • Sacraments: 7 Sacraments • Transubstantiation: Bread & wine become the literal body of Christ

MASTER KNOWLEDGE ORGANISER • KEY TOPIC 1: QUEEN, GOVERNMENT AND RELIGION, 1558–69	
1. CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & CONCEPTUAL DEFINITIONS • Royal Prerogative: The monarch's exclusive customary powers over foreign policy, declaring war, marriage, and religion. • Via Media: The "Middle Way": Elizabeth's religious settlement balancing Protestant doctrine with traditional ritual. • Act of Uniformity (1559): Mandated the Book of Common Prayer, church ornaments, vestments, and imposed a 1s recusancy fine. • Vestments Controversy: 1566 crisis where 37 Puritan vicars were suspended for refusing Archbishop Parker's order to wear surplices. • Crown Patronage: Granting titles, offices, lands, and monopolies to gentry and nobility to guarantee political loyalty. • Act of Supremacy (1559): Established Elizabeth as "Supreme Governor" of the Church of England, requiring all clergy to take an oath. • Recusancy: Refusing to attend compulsory Church of England Sunday services; practiced by devout Roman Catholics. • Casket Letters: Alleged love letters between Mary Queen of Scots and Bothwell used at the 1568 York inquiry to justify her detention.	
2. ESSENTIAL CHRONOLOGY • 1558: Elizabeth succeeds Mary I • 1559: Act of Supremacy passed • 1559: Act of Uniformity passed • 1559: Royal Injunctions issued • 1563: Thirty-Nine Articles drafted • 1566: Vestments Controversy (Parker) • 1567: Murder of Lord Darnley • 1568: Mary Stuart flees to England • 1568–69: York & Westminster inquiry • 1569: Northern Earls revolt breaks out	3. KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES MATRIX • Queen Elizabeth I: Tudor monarch (1558–1603); established Protestant settlement and resisted marriage. • Sir William Cecil: Principal Secretary & Lord Burghley; Elizabeth's most trusted Protestant statesman. • Matthew Parker: Archbishop of Canterbury (1559–75); drafted the 1566 Book of Advertisements. • Mary, Queen of Scots: Catholic cousin of Elizabeth; claimed English throne; fled Scotland in 1568. • Philip II of Spain: Catholic king of Spain and Netherlands; former husband of Mary I; rival to Elizabeth. • Robert Dudley: Earl of Leicester; Master of the Horse, royal favourite, and leading Puritan patron at court.
"Via Media: Neither Geneva nor Rome, but an English compromise designed to avoid civil war." 13/16	

GRADE 9 EXAM TECHNIQUE MASTERCLASS • PEARSON EDEXCEL PAPER 2 RUBRICS

1. THE 2/2 MARK FORMULA: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 • TARGET: 2 / 2

Mark Scheme Law: 1 mark for identifying a valid feature + 1 mark for supporting historical detail.

Grade 9 Model Answer: "One key feature of the Act of Supremacy (1559) was that it made Elizabeth Supreme Governor of the Church of England [1 mark]. Specifically, this title was chosen as a compromise to appease both Catholics who believed only the Pope was head of the Church, and Puritans who believed Christ was the only head [1 mark]."

2. THE 12/12 MARK FORMULA: EXPLAIN WHY [12 MARKS • 18 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 • TARGET: 11–12 / 12 (LEVEL 4)

Three PEEL Paragraphs: Use both provided stimulus points + introduce at least ONE distinct self-selected knowledge point. Every paragraph must feature explicit causal reasoning words (*Consequently, As a direct result, This meant that*).

Level 4 Linking Formula: Do not just list reasons! Connect them causally: "*This economic grievance did not operate in a vacuum; rather, it directly exacerbated religious fear because...*"

3. THE 16/16 MARK FORMULA: EVALUATIVE ESSAY [16 MARKS + 4 SPAG • 25 MINS]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 • TARGET: 15–16 / 16 (LEVEL 4)

Criteria-Led Judgment Architecture:

- **Introduction:** Define the key terms, state your overarching thesis, and establish your criteria for judgment (e.g. short-term threat vs long-term structural instability).
- **Paragraph 1 (Agree with Statement):** Rigorously analyze the stated factor with precise dates, statistics, and historical names.
- **Paragraphs 2 & 3 (Counter-Arguments):** Introduce other critical factors (including required own-knowledge beyond the stimulus points).
- **Conclusion:** Weigh the factors comparatively! Never write "both were important". Explain why one factor was the foundational catalyst while another was merely a symptom.

★ **Examiner Secret:** High-scoring Level 4 candidates establish explicit criteria in the first two sentences: "*In evaluating this statement, success must be judged by whether the policy achieved long-term institutional stability or merely temporary crisis containment...*"

#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) (2M)	Q1(B) (2M)	EXT (12/16M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	Enquiry 1.1: The situation on Elizabeth's accession, 1558	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
2	Enquiry 1.2: The 'settlement' of religion, 1559	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
3	Enquiry 1.3: Challenge to the religious settlement	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
4	Enquiry 1.4: The problem of Mary, Queen of Scots	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
KEY TOPIC 1 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		Do Now: [/ 40]	Q1(a): [/ 8]	Q1(b): [/ 8]	Ext: [/ 56]	[/ 112]

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK		Effort Grade: []
WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):	EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):	
Teacher Signature: _____		Date: __/__/2026

16/16

Key Topic 1 Mastery Complete • Cumulative Assessment & Digital Quizzing Hub